

BLUE CANVAS AI

AI Readiness & Opportunity Brief

Pre-Session Research & Analysis

Prepared for **Tim Clarke, Director — Quay Group**

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1 Company Overview

Quay Group is a specialist UHNW recruitment agency headquartered in Watford, UK. Founded in 2013 as Quay Crew, the company rebranded in June 2025 to reflect its expansion from superyacht crew placement into four specialist divisions:

2,000+

CANDIDATES PLACED

350+

SUPERYACHTS SERVED

12

YEARS IN MARKET

Four Divisions

Quay Crew — Superyacht crew recruitment, from deckhands to captains. The flagship division with deep industry expertise.

Quay Maritime — Land-based maritime roles at shipyards, yacht management firms, and marine corporate offices.

Quay Estates — Private estate staff: butlers, estate managers, household personnel for UHNW clients.

Quay Family Office — PAs, executive assistants, and C-suite placements for UHNW family offices.

Co-founded and directed by Tim Clarke alongside Caroline Clarke, the company is recognised across the superyacht industry for its thought leadership — publishing annual crew salary surveys, training reports, and market insights.

2 AI in Luxury & Maritime Recruitment

The recruitment industry is being transformed by AI, but luxury/UHNW and maritime recruitment lags behind mainstream adoption. This creates both a risk and an opportunity for Quay Group.

Where the industry is heading

AI-powered candidate matching is replacing keyword-based CV search. Platforms like HireVue, Eightfold, and Fetcher use semantic understanding to match candidates to roles based on skills, experience patterns, and cultural fit — not just keywords.

Automated sourcing and outreach tools can scan global candidate pools, social platforms, and maritime databases to surface passive candidates that manual search would miss.

Compliance automation is critical in maritime — STCW certifications, ENG1 medicals, flag state requirements, and visa status all have expiry dates. AI can track, alert, and verify these automatically.

Conversational AI is handling initial candidate screening, scheduling, and FAQ responses — freeing recruiters for high-value relationship work with UHNW clients.

Quay Group's Advantage

With 12 years of placement data, industry surveys, and deep client relationships, Quay Group has the data foundation that most competitors lack. The question isn't whether to adopt AI — it's which applications deliver the fastest ROI while preserving the personal, high-touch service that UHNW clients expect.

3 AI Opportunities for Quay Group

Ranked by a combination of business impact and ease of implementation. Quick wins first, strategic plays later.

1. AI-Powered CV Screening & Candidate Matching

QUICK WIN

Use AI to parse incoming CVs, extract structured data (certifications, vessel experience, languages), and automatically match candidates to open roles across all four divisions. Reduces time-to-shortlist from hours to minutes.

Impact  Ease 

2. Certification & Compliance Tracker

QUICK WIN

Automated tracking of STCW, ENG1, flag state docs, and visa expiry across your candidate database. Proactive alerts to candidates and clients before expiry. Eliminates manual spreadsheet tracking and reduces placement risk.

Impact  Ease 

3. Intelligent Candidate Outreach & Nurturing

MEDIUM TERM

AI-drafted personalised outreach to passive candidates based on their profile, career stage, and vessel preferences. Multilingual capability is key — superyacht crew come from 50+ nationalities. Automated follow-ups keep your talent pipeline warm without manual effort.

Impact  Ease 

4. Salary & Market Intelligence Automation

MEDIUM TERM

You already produce industry-leading salary surveys manually. AI can continuously aggregate market data, job postings, and industry trends to provide real-time benchmarking. This becomes a premium product you can offer clients — and a competitive moat.

Impact  Ease 

5. Client Relationship & CRM Intelligence

QUICK WIN

AI-enhanced CRM that surfaces client insights, predicts hiring needs based on vessel schedules/seasons, and drafts personalised check-in communications. Particularly valuable as you scale across four divisions — ensuring no client falls through the cracks.

Impact  Ease 

6. Content & Thought Leadership at Scale

QUICK WIN

AI-assisted blog posts, social content, and industry reports. Your existing thought leadership (Tim's articles, salary surveys) can be amplified 3-5x with AI drafting, research, and distribution — maintaining your market authority as you grow.

Impact  Ease 

7. Cross-Division Candidate Intelligence

STRATEGIC

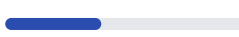
With four divisions, candidates often transition between sectors (yacht crew → estate staff → family office). An AI system that identifies cross-placement opportunities from your existing database could unlock significant revenue from candidates you've already placed.

Impact  Ease 

8. Rotation & Availability Scheduling

STRATEGIC

Your survey data shows crew rotation is increasingly complex. An AI-powered scheduling system that tracks crew rotation patterns, availability windows, and preference matching could become a value-add platform for yacht management clients.

Impact  Ease 

4 Discovery Questions

To make the most of our session, it helps to think about these areas in advance:

- ? What does a typical recruitment workflow look like from job brief to placement? Where are the bottlenecks?
- ? How are CVs currently received, stored, and searched? What ATS/CRM do you use?
- ? How do you currently track crew certifications and document expiry dates?
- ? What's the biggest time drain for your consultants week-to-week?
- ? How do the four divisions share candidate data and client relationships today?
- ? What does your candidate sourcing process look like for hard-to-fill roles?
- ? How are your annual salary surveys currently compiled? What data sources?
- ? Are there any tools or software you've tried and abandoned? What didn't work?
- ? What would "AI success" look like for Quay Group in 12 months?

5 What to Expect from the Session

This is a collaborative, practical half-day — not a lecture. We'll work through your specific business together and leave with a clear action plan.

45 MINUTES

Prioritisation Workshop

Rank opportunities by ROI, feasibility, and strategic fit. Build your shortlist.

45 MINUTES

Quick Wins Demo

Hands-on demonstration of 2–3 tools you can use within weeks.



AI consultancy for ambitious businesses

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